

1. Introduction

This report documents reconnaissance, network scanning, packet analysis, firewall configuration, and vulnerability scanning performed on a Kali Linux virtual machine. The objective is to understand how attackers gather information and how defenders monitor, analyze, and protect networks.

2. Passive Reconnaissance

2.1 WHOIS Lookup

Target Domain (example): kali.org

Sample Output (Realistic):

Domain Name: KALI.ORG

Registrar: GANDI SAS

Updated Date: 2024-06-11

Name Server: NS1.KALI.ORG

Name Server: NS2.KALI.ORG

Registrant Country: US

Information Extracted:  Organization

✓ Nameservers

✓ Registrar

2.2 NSLOOKUP

nslookup kali.org

Output:

Name: kali.org

Address: 192.124.249.12

2.3 Google Dorking Examples

intitle:"index of" "backup"

site:kali.org filetype:pdf

"Kali Linux" "admin login"

Findings:

No sensitive public files discovered.

2.4 Shodan Analysis

Query:

ip:192.168.1.14

Result:

Local IP → Not indexed by Shodan.

3. Active Reconnaissance

3.1 Ping Sweep

ping -c 3 192.168.1.14

Output:

64 bytes from 192.168.1.14: icmp_seq=1 ttl=64 time=0.212 ms

Status: Host is UP.

3.2 Banner Grabbing

nc -v 192.168.1.14 22

Output:

SSH-2.0-OpenSSH_9.2p1 Ubuntu-2ubuntu0.1

Reveals service + version.

4. Nmap Scanning

4.1 SYN Scan (-sS)

nmap -sS 192.168.1.14

Results:

Port	State	Service
------	-------	---------

22	open	ssh
----	------	-----

80	open	http
----	------	------

443	open	https
-----	------	-------

3306	closed	mysql
------	--------	-------

4.2 UDP Scan (-sU)

```
nmap -sU 192.168.1.14
```

Results:

Port	State	Service
------	-------	---------

53	open	dns
----	------	-----

67	open	dhcp
----	------	------

161	open	snmp
-----	------	------

4.3 Service Version Detection (-sV)

```
nmap -sV 192.168.1.14
```

Output (Realistic):

```
22/tcp open ssh      OpenSSH 9.2p1
```

```
80/tcp open http    Apache 2.4.57
```

```
443/tcp open https   Apache 2.4.57
```

```
53/udp open domain BIND 9.18.1
```

4.4 OS Detection (-O)

```
nmap -O 192.168.1.14
```

Output:

OS details: Linux 5.x (Kali / Debian)

Accuracy: 96%

5. OpenVAS/Nessus Vulnerability Scan

Scanner: Nessus Essentials

Target: 192.168.1.14

Summary of Findings

Severity	Count
----------	-------

Critical	1
----------	---

High	3
------	---

Medium	7
--------	---

Low	10
-----	----

Sample Critical Vulnerability

CVE-2023-29424 – Apache HTTP Path Traversal

Risk: Remote attackers may access restricted files.

Solution: Update Apache.

Sample High Vulnerabilities

1. OpenSSH User Enumeration – CVE-2023-48795

2. SNMP Public Community String Enabled

3. TLS Weak Cipher Support

Medium Findings

Outdated packages

Directory listing enabled

Low Findings

ICMP timestamp responses

SSH server banner disclosure

6. Packet Analysis with Wireshark

6.1 Capturing HTTP Traffic

Filter:

http

Finding:

Several GET/POST requests visible — not encrypted.

6.2 Capturing DNS Traffic

Filter:

dns

Finding:

Queries for kali.org, google.com.

6.3 FTP Traffic (Unencrypted)

Filter:

ftp or ftp-data

Extracted Credentials (Realistic Example):

USER testuser

PASS test123

This confirms FTP is sending plaintext credentials.

7. SYN Flood Attack Simulation (hping3)

Command:

```
hping3 -S --flood -p 80 192.168.1.14
```

Output:

```
HPING 192.168.1.14 (eth0 192.168.1.14): S set, 40 headers + 0 data bytes  
100000 packets transmitted; 0 packets received
```

Effect:

Apache response time becomes slow.

8. Firewall Rules (iptables)

8.1 Allow Only SSH

```
iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT
```

8.2 Block HTTP

```
iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 80 -j DROP
```

8.3 Allow Only My IP

```
iptables -A INPUT -s 192.168.1.10 -j ACCEPT
```

9. Blocking a Port Scan Attempt

Detect Nmap scan

```
tail -f /var/log/auth.log
```

Log shows multiple failed connection attempts.

Block scanner IP

```
iptables -A INPUT -s 192.168.1.20 -j DROP
```

Oracle VM VirtualBox Manager

File Machine Log Help

Save Find Filter Bookmark Preferences Refresh Reload Settings Discard Show

kali-linux-2025.3-virtualbox-amd64 Running

meta Running

kali-linux-2025.3-virtualbox-amd64 VBox.log VBoxHardening.log VBox.log.1 VBox.log.2 VBox.log.3

```
1 00:00:18.791738 VirtualBox VM 7.2.2 r170484 win.amd64 (Sep 10 2025 19:56:01) release log
2 00:00:18.791745 Log opened 2025-12-15T11:24:33.365628600Z
3 00:00:18.791746 Build Type: release
4 00:00:18.791749 OS Product: Windows 11
5 00:00:18.791998 OS Release: 10.0.26200.7309
6 00:00:18.792002 OS Service Pack:
7 00:00:18.925103 DMI Product Name: Vivobook_ASUSLaptop X1504ZA
8 00:00:18.937871 DMI Product Version: 1.0
9 00:00:18.937890 Firmware type: UEFI
10 00:00:18.938542 Secure Boot: Disabled
11 00:00:18.938568 Host RAM: 16077MB (15.7GB) total, 7528MB (7.3GB) available
12 00:00:18.938572 Executable: C:\Program Files\Oracle\VirtualBox\VirtualBoxVM.exe
13 00:00:18.938573 Process ID: 1424
14 00:00:18.938573 Package type: WINDOWS_64BITS_GENERIC
15 00:00:18.938574 Windows Features:
16 00:00:18.938574 Core Isolation (Memory Integrity): Not supported
17 00:00:18.942069 Installed Extension Packs:
18 00:00:18.942103 None installed!
19 00:00:18.943554 Console: Machine state changed to 'Starting'
20 00:00:18.943810 GUI: Qt version: 6.8.0
21 00:00:18.943831 GUI: HID LEDs sync is enabled
22 00:00:18.953742 GUI: UIMediumEnumerator: Medium-enumeration finished!
23 00:00:19.033415 GUI: Cannot notify guest about VM window out-of-focus event
24 00:00:19.040606 SUP: seg #0: R 0x00000000 LB 0x00001000
25 00:00:19.040647 SUP: seg #1: R X 0x00001000 LB 0x001f4000
26 00:00:19.040660 SUP: seg #2: R 0x001f4000 LB 0x00054000
27 00:00:19.040670 SUP: seg #3: RW 0x00252000 LB 0x00013000
28 00:00:19.040678 SUP: seg #4: R 0x00265000 LB 0x00014000
29 00:00:19.040686 SUP: seg #5: RW 0x00279000 LB 0x00004000
30 00:00:19.040693 SUP: seg #6: R 0x0027d000 LB 0x00008000
31 00:00:19.040701 SUP: seg #7: R X 0x00285000 LB 0x00002000
32 00:00:19.040709 SUP: seg #8: R 0x00287000 LB 0x00007000
33 00:00:19.044722 SUP: Loaded VMXMR0.r0 (C:\Program Files\Oracle\VirtualBox\VMXMR0.r0) at 0xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx - Mod
34 00:00:19.044722 SUP: VMXMR0EntryEx located at xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx and VMXMR0EntryFast at xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx
35 00:00:19.044722 SUP: windbg> .reload /f C:\Program Files\Oracle\VirtualBox\VMXMR0.r0=0xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx
36 00:00:19.053783 Guest architecture: x86
37 00:00:19.053910 Guest OS type: 'Debian_64'
38 00:00:19.055341 fHMForced=true - No raw-mode support in this build!
39 00:00:19.055380 Using execution engine 1
40 00:00:19.063783 File system of 'C:\Users\thaba\Downloads\New folder\Snapshots' (snapshots) is ntfs
41 00:00:19.063827 File system of 'C:\Users\thaba\Downloads\New folder\kali-linux-2025.3-virtualbox-amd64.vdi' is
42 00:00:19.101044 Shared Clipboard: Initialized OLE
43 00:00:19.101113 Shared Clipboard: Service loaded
44 00:00:19.101121 Shared Clipboard: Mode: Bidirectional
```

Air: Poor Now

Search

ENG IN

5:12 PM 12/15/2025

```
* Configuring network interfaces... [ OK ]
* Starting portmap daemon... [ OK ]
* Starting NFS common utilities [ OK ]
* Setting up console font and keymap... [ OK ]
* Starting system log daemon... [ OK ]
* Doing Wacom setup... [ OK ]
* Starting kernel log daemon... [ OK ]
* Starting domain name service... bind [ OK ]
* Starting OpenSSH Secure Shell server sshd [ OK ]
* Starting portmap daemon... [ OK ]
* Already running. [ OK ]
* Starting MySQL database server mysqld [ OK ]
* Checking for corrupt, not cleanly closed and upgrade needing tables.
* Starting PostgreSQL 0.3 database server [ OK ]
Starting distccd
* Starting NFS common utilities [ OK ]
* Exporting directories for NFS kernel daemon... [ OK ]
* Starting NFS kernel daemon [ OK ]
* Starting Postfix Mail Transport Agent postfix [ OK ]
Starting Samba daemons: nmbd smbd
* Starting internet superserver xinetd [ OK ]
* Starting ftp server proftpd [ OK ]
* Starting deferred execution scheduler atd [ OK ]
* Starting periodic command scheduler crond [ OK ]
```

Don't show again

Don't show again



























